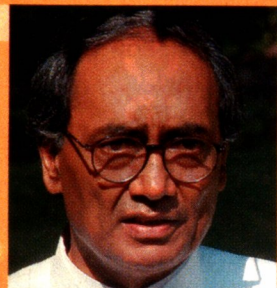
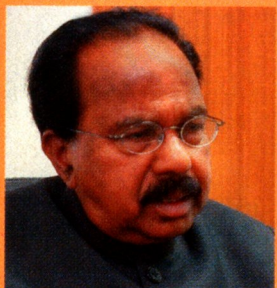


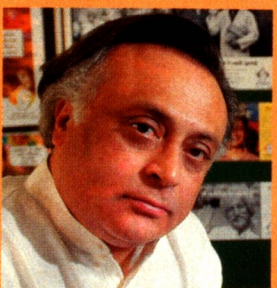
THE WINNERS



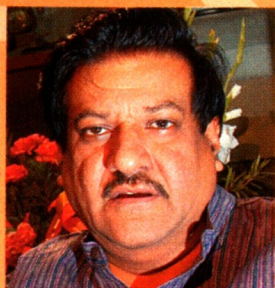
DIGVIJAY SINGH: The voice of experience in Team Rahul. Will have to script the party's turnaround in Uttar Pradesh. Also heads the publicity wing.



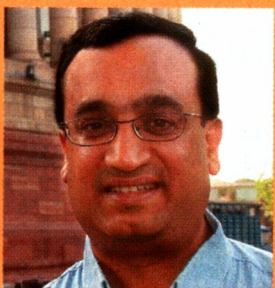
VEERAPPA MOILY: Now in the limelight as the new boss of the media cell. Also heads the controversial DEPCO that badly needs a makeover. In-charge of two states.



JAIRAM RAMESH: Finds place in various committees including DEPCO and is convener of Rahul's think-tank on future challenges.



PRITHVIRAJ CHAVAN: Now both in the PMO and party headquarters. As general secretary, will handle five states. Will give vital inputs as part of Rahul's think-tank.



AJAY MAKEN: The young minister of state has been given the charge of Jharkhand and Orissa. His involvement in other states should keep him out of Delhi politics.

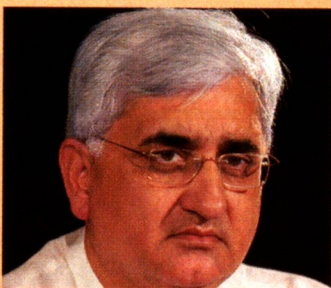


MOHSINA KIDWAI: The Indira-loyalist is general secretary again handling four states, including Kerala and West Bengal, and the Mahila Congress.

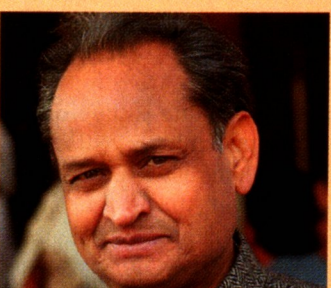
THE LOSERS



JANARDAN DWIVEDI: Sonia's Hindi speechwriter continues to be a general secretary but ceases to be media chairperson and has lost the charge of both Punjab and Haryana. Will handle the training cell instead.



SALMAN KHURSHID: Has been removed from the post of UPCC chief. Despite his connections, finds himself out of the loop within the organisational set-up, barring a role in the new think-tank.



ASHOK GEHLOT: Has lost charge of Uttar Pradesh and is left only with Delhi. Wanted to go back to his state, but has been kept out of Rajasthan.

eral secretary, the young dynast has not been given a state to handle. The charge of the youth wing brings him within the organisational ambit but without any real responsibility that can be thrown at his face by the Opposition, if he fails. Until now, Rahul has been a loner, looking for a support group outside the organisational structure rather than within. In April, when he got into his Toyota Land Cruiser and zipped off to Uttar Pradesh to campaign for the Assembly polls, the party headquarters had no clue of his plans. His entire operation was handled by his team of young MPs. The Boston-educated Milind Deora manned the control room along with NRI lawyer-turned-MP Madhu Goud Yaskhi while an old Doon School buddy Jitin Prasada helped organise the roadshows on the ground. Now all these faces have been legitimised and are part of the new look of the party. Like the cricket team, Sonia has also brought the GenNext on to the batting field. As she said with a smile when asked about the timing of the reshuffle, "As a political party, we need to be prepared for all eventualities."

But more than his parliamentary chums, Rahul will also now have to take the cadre along with him. The time for playing lone ranger is over. The shift to a general secretary room at AICC is part of this outreach programme. Rahul will now have to meet the *aam admi* and be the interface between the party worker and his mother. This is exactly the role that both Sanjay and Rajiv played for their mother Indira. Even before he became a general secretary, Rajiv had successfully organised the 1982 Asian Games and already had his core team of two Aruns (Nehru and Singh) in place. Sanjay took over the party's youth wing first and became an MP later while Indira made her political debut with the Vanar Sena. Seen in this context, Rahul's adventures in Uttar Pradesh follow a familiar pattern.

The entire reshuffle has one objective: to give a youthful look to the organisation, bringing in performers rather than shuffling old family retainers.

Earlier, the joke within the party was "Congress *ka haath* walking stick *ke saath*". This is no longer the case. It is a blend of fresh faces with the young MPs being brought in to work alongside